



LANE COUNTY · SELLING YOUR HOME · FALL 2026

The *real* cost of listing too high

"We can always come down" sounds safe. It isn't free. This walks through what overpricing actually costs in time and dollars, what's worth fixing before the photos, and what the timeline really looks like once you're under contract.



5

BUSINESS DAYS EARNEST MONEY IS TYPICALLY DUE AFTER ACCEPTANCE

10

BUSINESS DAYS A BUYER TYPICALLY HAS TO INSPECT

30-45

DAYS FROM ACCEPTANCE TO CLOSING ON A TYPICAL LANE COUNTY CONTRACT



01 · THE OVERPRICING MATH

Do the math *before* you list, not after

Here's the thing nobody says out loud when they tell you to "list a little high, we can always come down": every extra day on market costs you something, and dropping the price later doesn't get that day back.

Try this with your own numbers:

\$	X	=
YOUR MORTGAGE + TAXES + INSURANCE + UTILITIES, PER MONTH	THE EXTRA MONTHS YOU EXPECT TO SIT BEFORE A PRICE CUT	WHAT "A LITTLE HIGH" ACTUALLY COSTS YOU

That's the carrying cost. It's real money, and it's separate from the other cost: a price cut is public. Buyers and their agents can see how long a listing has sat and whether the price moved. A home that's been sitting starts to look like something's wrong with it, even when nothing is.

The home that's priced right the first time usually nets more than the home that chases the market down. [Text 541.784.7745 to run your numbers →](#)

02 · WHY OVERPRICED HOMES SIT

Buyers don't find your home, they find your price band

Most buyers are searching with a price filter, not a street name. If you're \$20,000 over where the market says you should be, you're not getting seen by the buyers who were actually shopping for your home. You're getting seen by buyers for the *next* price band up, and they're comparing you to homes with another bedroom or another acre.



- **The first two weeks matter most.** That's when a listing gets the most eyes and the most showings. Price it right and you spend that window creating competition. Price it high and you spend that window getting passed over.
- **A price reduction doesn't reset the clock.** Days on market keeps counting, and buyers can usually see the history.

03 · WHAT'S WORTH FIXING BEFORE THE PHOTOS

Spend where it shows, skip what doesn't

Not every repair pays for itself before a sale. A rough rule that holds up:

USUALLY WORTH DOING

USUALLY NOT WORTH DOING BEFORE LISTING

Fresh paint in neutral tones

A full kitchen or bath remodel

Decluttering and deep cleaning

Replacing a roof with real life left on it

Fixing anything that moves, leaks, or sticks (doors, faucets, outlets)

Upgrading finishes a buyer will likely change anyway

Curb appeal — lawn, porch light, a clean front door

Landscaping beyond basic tidiness

Addressing anything that would show up on an inspection report anyway

Anything cosmetic in a room a buyer won't spend time in



One exception on well and septic systems, barns, outbuildings, and anything rural-specific: those are disclosure items, not staging items. If it's a real issue, it's better on the table before an offer than found during the buyer's inspection.

04 · WHAT THE TIMELINE ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

From accepted offer to keys

A typical Lane County contract runs something like this once you're under contract:

1. **Earnest money due**, usually within 5 business days of mutual acceptance.
2. **Inspection period**, usually 10 business days — this is when most repair conversations happen.
3. **Closing**, typically 30 to 45 days out from acceptance, depending on financing.

Every contract is its own document, and your actual dates will be in it — this is the shape to expect, not a guarantee.



05 · WHAT TO DO NEXT

Before you pick a number

1. **Run the carrying-cost math above with your real numbers.** It changes the conversation about where to start.
2. **Walk the house with a critical eye**, or let me do it — I'll tell you what's worth fixing and what isn't, honestly, before you spend a dollar.
3. **Ask for a real number, not a guess.** A proper comparison against what's actually sold near you, not what's still sitting on the market unsold.

Text 541.784.7745 when you're ready, or just reply with your address and I'll start pulling what's actually sold near you.